



The Windows Desktop

A simple guide to your computer screen, icons, and how to find things easily.

8.1 The Desktop

8.2 Parts of the Screen

8.3 Taskbar & Tray

8.4 Finding Programs

8.5 Window Buttons

8.6 Move & Resize



What We Cover Today



Introduction to Computers



Parts of a Computer (Hardware)



Software



Input & Output Devices



Storage Devices



Practice & Weekly Quiz



Operating Systems

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Mouse & Keyboard Skills

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System Management & Troubleshooting

Recap: Unit 7



What is an OS?

The main software that runs first when you turn on your PC — the bridge to your hardware.



What It Does

Runs your apps, manages memory, and keeps your files organized — all at once.



Popular Systems

Windows, macOS, Linux, Chrome OS on computers; Android and iOS on phones.



How It Starts Up

Power On → Self-Test → Load OS → Ready! This all happens in seconds.

? Quick check: what do you call the Windows logo button at the bottom-left of your screen?

Today's Objectives



Understand the Desktop

Explain what the Desktop is and identify its main parts.



Use the Taskbar

Read the Taskbar and System Tray to check programs, time, and Wi-Fi.



Find & Control Programs

Use the Start Menu, and Minimize / Maximize / Close any window.



Get Hands-On

Move and resize a window, and practice with Notepad and Calculator.

 We'll close with a hands-on lab and a quick class discussion — keep these four goals in mind.



UNIT 08

The Windows Desktop

A simple guide to your computer screen, icons, and how to find things easily.



Your Digital Work Table



The First Screen

When you turn on your computer, the first main screen you see is called the Desktop.



Like a Real Desk

Think of it like a real office desk. It holds your files, tools, and folders so you can start working quickly.



Change the Picture

Tip: You can right-click on any empty space on the screen to change your background picture (wallpaper).

Main Parts of the Desktop

Part Name	What It Is	How to Use It
 Icons	Small pictures on the screen. They stand for programs, files, or folders.	Double-click on an icon with your mouse to open it.
 Taskbar	The long bar at the bottom of your screen. It shows your open programs.	Click once on any program icon on the bar to open or switch to it.
 Start Button	The Windows logo button on the bottom-left corner of the screen.	Click it to find all your programs and turn off the computer.
 System Tray	The small area on the bottom-right corner of the taskbar.	Look here to see the time, change sound volume, or connect to Wi-Fi.



The Taskbar & System Tray

See Open Programs

The Taskbar at the bottom shows you which programs are open. It helps you switch between different tasks quickly.

Quick Settings and Alerts

The System Tray on the bottom-right corner shows important settings and alerts about your computer.

IMPORTANT STATUS ICONS:



Time and Date

Click here to see a simple calendar.



Internet (Wi-Fi)

Check if you are connected to the internet.



Speaker Sound

Click to make your computer sound louder or quieter.

How to Find Your Programs



The Start Menu

Click the Start Button to see a list of every program installed on your computer.



Easy Typing Search

Fast Search: You do not need to look through long lists. Just click the Start Button and type the name of the program to find it instantly.

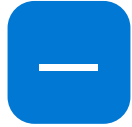


Turn Off the Computer

Click the power icon in the Start Menu to safely shut down, restart, or put your computer to sleep.

The Three Window Buttons

Every program opens inside a rectangular box called a Window. At the top-right corner, you will see three simple buttons to control it:



Minimize (—)

Hides the window. The program stays open down in the bottom bar, so you can click it to open it again.



Maximize (□)

Makes the window grow to fill the whole screen. This helps you read and see your work much better.



Close (X)

Closes the program completely when you are finished working with it.

Moving and Resizing Windows



How to Move a Window

You can drag program windows to any spot on your screen.

Steps: Click and hold the top bar (Title Bar) of the window, drag it with your mouse, and let go of the mouse button.



How to Change the Size

You can make a window wider, taller, or smaller.

Steps: Put your mouse arrow on any edge or corner of the window. When the arrow turns into a double-headed cursor, drag to resize.

Let's Try It Together!

- 1 Open the Notepad program using the Start Menu search.
- 2 Click Minimize, then click its icon on the taskbar to bring it back.
- 3 Click Maximize, then click it again to make it smaller.
- 4 Move and change the size of your Notepad window.
- 5 Click Close, and try the same steps with the Calculator.

SESSION STATUS: ACTIVE PRACTICE

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>> Starting your practice time...  
>> Open a program to begin.  
>> Notepad opened successfully!  
>> Minimize and Maximize signals OK.  
>> Notepad closed. Calculator next!
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Show What You Know!

Q1



Which button hides a window down into the bottom bar?

Q2



Where on your screen do you find the clock, sound volume, and Wi-Fi?

Q3



How do you move a program window to a different part of the screen?



Key Takeaways



The Desktop

The first screen you see when you turn on your computer — your digital work table with icons, files, and folders ready to use.



Taskbar & System Tray

The Taskbar (bottom bar) shows open programs. The System Tray (bottom-right) shows time, Wi-Fi, and sound volume.



Start Menu

Click Start to see every program, or type to search instantly. The power icon safely shuts down or restarts your PC.



Window Controls

Minimize (—) hides it, Maximize (□) fills the screen, Close (X) ends it. Drag the title bar to move, drag an edge to resize.

Next up — Unit 9: Mouse & Keyboard Skills



What You Learned Today

Lab complete — everything from this lesson in one place.

WINDOWS DESKTOP — REFERENCE



Screen Parts

Icons

Double-click to open

Taskbar

Click to switch programs

Start Button

Find programs & shut down

System Tray

Time, Wi-Fi, volume



Window Buttons

— Minimize

Hides to the taskbar

□ Maximize

Fills the whole screen

✕ Close

Ends the program

Move / Resize

Drag title bar / edge



Start Menu

Click Start to browse every program, or type the program's name to search instantly.

Status Icons

🕒 Time & Date — calendar

📶 Wi-Fi — internet check

🔊 Speaker — volume

💡 *Right-click empty Desktop space to change your wallpaper.*

The Desktop is your starting point. The Taskbar, Start Menu, and window buttons help you get everything done.